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Study Courses

Non-EU students can apply for a first residence permit for the purpose of study if they are enrolled in the following types of programs:

- Higher education programs (undergraduate, master's, or doctoral studies) at a recognized Slovenian university or higher education institution.
- Vocational and technical education programs.
- Secondary school education (within an international exchange program or other approved programs).
- Language courses or other forms of education that are part of a recognized educational program.
- Researcher or scientist programs at recognized research organizations.

Embassy Appointment

Booking an appointment for a residence permit application (often referred to as a study visa application) follows these procedures:

- Locate the competent diplomatic mission or consulate of the Republic of Slovenia in your country of residence.
- Check the official website of the specific embassy; most require booking via an online appointment system.
- In some jurisdictions where no online system exists, appointments must be requested via email or telephone.
- Ensure the appointment is booked well in advance, as slots may be limited during peak enrollment periods (June to September).

Applying for a Study Visa

In Slovenia, for stays longer than 90 days, students apply for a First Residence Permit for the Purpose of Study.

Steps to Apply

- Receive the certificate of enrollment from the Slovenian educational institution.
- Gather all required documents including criminal record certificates and proof of funds.
- Submit the application in person at the Slovenian embassy or consulate in your home country.
- Provide biometric data (fingerprints) at the embassy.

- The embassy forwards the application to the relevant Administrative Unit (Upravna enota) in Slovenia for decision-making.
- Wait for the notification of approval.
- Collect the permit at the embassy or, in some cases, a Long-stay Visa (D) is issued to enter Slovenia and collect the card.

Processing Time

- The statutory deadline for a decision is 30 to 60 days.
- In practice, the process can take between 2 and 4 months depending on the completeness of the file and the workload of the Administrative Unit.

Documents Needed

The following documents are mandatory for the application:

- Completed and signed application form for a first residence permit.
- Valid passport with a validity exceeding the intended stay by at least three months.
- A compliant passport-sized photograph.
- Proof of admission or enrollment certificate from the educational institution.
- Proof of sufficient financial means for the duration of the stay.
- Proof of health insurance covering at least emergency medical services in Slovenia.
- Police clearance certificate (criminal record) from the home country, not older than three months, translated into Slovenian and properly authenticated (Apostille if applicable).
- Proof of payment of the administrative fee.

Money Requirements

Students must prove they have sufficient monthly income to cover their living costs.

The required amount is equal to the “Basic Minimum Income” in Slovenia.

- As of 2024, the required amount is approximately 484.88 EUR per month.
- As of 2024, the required amount is 494.09 EUR per month. (Source: University of Ljubljana / gov.si)
- Students must show they possess this amount for every month of their stay (usually for a 12-month period).
- Acceptable proof includes personal bank statements, proof of scholarship, or a notarized statement from parents/legal guardians promising financial support accompanied by their bank statements.
- A notarized statement from parents/legal guardians is not required to be notarized; a written declaration (in English or Slovenian) from the parent/guardian obligated to support the student is sufficient, accompanied by their bank statements. (Source: infotujci.si / University of Ljubljana)

Residence Permit

While the application is usually initiated abroad, certain procedures happen after arrival:

- If the permit was granted before travel, the student collects the physical residence permit card.
- If the student entered with a Visa D, they must visit the local Administrative Unit (Upravna enota) to finalize the permit.
- All students must register their temporary residence at the Administrative Unit or the local police station within three days of arrival (or three days after moving into a private apartment).
- Students who already hold a valid residence permit must register their temporary residence address within eight days of the delivery of the permit, not three days from arrival. The three-day rule applies only to those without a valid residence permit or visa, who must register at the nearest police station. (Source: infotujci.si)
- If staying in a student dormitory or hotel, the landlord usually handles the registration of residence.

Working While Studying

Non-EU students in Slovenia are permitted to work under specific conditions:

- Type of work: "Student Work" (Študentsko delo).
- Requirement: Students must join a "Student Service" (Študentski servis), which acts as a specialized employment agency.
- Hours: There is no strict weekly hour limit for students, provided they maintain their academic performance and status.
- Documentation: A valid student status and a tax residency number in Slovenia are required.
- Payment: There is a legal minimum hourly rate for student work, which is adjusted annually.

Renewing the Residence Permit

If the study program lasts longer than one year, the permit must be renewed annually:

- The application for renewal must be submitted to the Administrative Unit in Slovenia.
- The application must be filed at least 30 days before the current permit expires.
- Documents required include proof of continued enrollment, proof of academic progress (passed exams), updated health insurance, and updated proof of funds.

Changing to a Work Permit

Slovenia allows graduates to remain in the country to seek employment:

- Graduates can apply for a residence permit for "Job Seeking or Entrepreneurship" for a period of up to 9 months after completing their studies.
- Once a job is found, the employer must apply for a Single Work and Residence Permit.
- The student can change their status from a study permit or a job-seeking permit to a work permit without having to leave the country.

Official Information

Official legal information and updates can be found on the following governmental portals:

- Infotujci.si (The official national portal for foreigners).
- GOV.si (Website of the Ministry of the Interior and Ministry of Foreign Affairs).
- E-uprava.gov.si (The state's e-government portal).

Application Forms

Forms can be downloaded from official government websites:

- The application for a first temporary residence permit (Form 2/1) is available on the Infotujci.si "Forms" section.
- Forms are also available on the E-uprava portal under the "Foreigners" section.
- Physical forms can be obtained at any Slovenian embassy or Administrative Unit.

Tips for Students

To avoid delays or rejections, students should consider the following:

- Authenticating documents: Ensure the police clearance certificate has the correct Apostille or legalization; without this, the document is not legally valid in Slovenia.
- Translations: All documents in foreign languages must be translated into Slovenian by a certified court translator.
- Bank Statements: Ensure bank statements clearly show the account holder's name and sufficient closing balances; simple printouts without official stamps may be rejected.
- Timelines: Start the process as soon as the enrollment certificate is received, as the administrative process can be slow.
- Health Insurance: Verify that the insurance policy meets the specific coverage requirements; standard travel insurance is often insufficient for a residence permit.

1. Study Courses That Qualify

A non-EU (third-country) national can apply for a study residence permit if they are:

- Enrolled in a university programme (bachelor's, master's, or doctoral level)
- Enrolled in another recognized form of education, specialisation, professional training, or practical training
- Participating in an international study-exchange programme, or another programme that is not part of the formal education system

In all cases, the applicant must also obtain a residence permit for the purpose of studying.

2. Booking an Embassy or Consulate Appointment

- The application for a first temporary residence permit for study purposes is normally submitted at a Slovenian diplomatic mission or consular post abroad.
- Find the relevant embassy or consulate using the official directory: Slovenia's representations abroad (gov.si).
- Appointment booking methods are set by each individual embassy or consulate (by phone, email, or an online system), since there is no single centralized booking portal for all posts. Check the specific embassy's website for its appointment procedure before applying.
- If there is no Slovenian representation in your country, the relevant instructions (e.g. applying through a neighboring country's mission) are listed on the same gov.si page.
- If you are already legally in Slovenia (e.g. on a valid visa or residence permit from another EU country) you may instead apply at the competent administrative unit (*upravna enota*) in Slovenia. Larger units, such as Ljubljana, use appointment systems (phone booking or the "UE Naročanje" online scheduler).

3. Steps to Apply for a Study Visa / Residence Permit

Where to apply

- First application: at a Slovenian embassy or consulate abroad, OR
- At a competent administrative unit in Slovenia, if you are already legally residing there (e.g. on a valid ID/passport with EU residence permit, a Schengen visa C, or a visa D issued by another EU state for study purposes) and submit proof of enrolment. In this case you may stay up to 90 days from entry, or until your visa/permit expires if shorter, and must apply before that period ends.

Documents needed — see Section 4 below.

How to apply

1. Gather all required documents (see below).
2. Submit the application using official form no. 8/1 (Annex 1 of the Rules on issuing residence permits).
3. Pay the applicable administrative fee.
4. If applying inside Slovenia, you will receive a certificate of timely application, which acts as a temporary permit until a final decision is made.
5. Once approved, collect your biometric residence permit card.

How long it usually takes

- Official sources do not publish a fixed number of processing days; timing depends on the embassy/administrative unit and the completeness of your file.
- The certificate of timely application allows you to stay in Slovenia legally while the decision is pending.
- It is advisable to apply as early as possible before your intended start date, since embassy appointment slots and document preparation (translations, apostilles) can take time.

4. Documents Needed

According to the official document list for a temporary residence permit for study purposes, you must submit:

- A personal photograph
- A valid travel document (passport), or a certified copy, valid at least 3 months beyond your intended stay
- Proof of adequate health insurance covering at least emergency medical services in Slovenia (if you are not otherwise compulsorily insured)
- Proof of sufficient means of subsistence (see Section 5)
- A criminal record certificate from your home country (not older than 3 months; officially translated into Slovene, and apostilled/legalised if required)
- Evidence of acceptance/enrolment issued by the educational institution, or confirmation from the relevant state authority or grant-awarding body
- Confirmation of your address in Slovenia (e.g. rental contract or owner's statement), if applying inside Slovenia

5. Money Requirements

- The legal standard is "sufficient means of subsistence," defined as an amount at least equal to the basic amount of minimum income in Slovenia, adjusted periodically for inflation.

- As of April 2026, this basic amount is EUR 507.43 per month (the figure is updated regularly, so check the current value before applying).
- Funds must be sufficient to cover the entire intended period of residence (e.g. 9 months of study requires proof of funds for all 9 months).
- Accepted proof includes:
 - Bank statements or savings showing sufficient funds
 - A scholarship or grant confirmation
 - A written statement from parents or legal guardians, if they are legally obliged to support you under the law of your home country
 - An employment contract or job offer, if you intend to work in Slovenia

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- Enrolled in a university programme (bachelor's, master's, or doctoral level)
- Enrolled in another recognized form of education, specialisation, professional training, or practical training
- Participating in an international study-exchange programme, or another programme that is not part of the formal education system

In all cases, the applicant must also obtain a residence permit for the purpose of studying.

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How to apply

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7. Submit the application using official form no. 8/1 (Annex 1 of the Rules on issuing residence permits).
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10. Once approved, collect your biometric residence permit card.

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- Official sources do not publish a fixed number of processing days; timing depends on the embassy/administrative unit and the completeness of your file.
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- It is advisable to apply as early as possible before your intended start date, since embassy appointment slots and document preparation (translations, apostilles) can take time.

4. Documents Needed

According to the official document list for a temporary residence permit for study purposes, you must submit:

- A personal photograph
- A valid travel document (passport), or a certified copy, valid at least 3 months beyond your intended stay
- Proof of adequate health insurance covering at least emergency medical services in Slovenia (if you are not otherwise compulsorily insured)
- Proof of sufficient means of subsistence (see Section 5)
- A criminal record certificate from your home country (not older than 3 months; officially translated into Slovene, and apostilled/legalised if required)

- Evidence of acceptance/enrolment issued by the educational institution, or confirmation from the relevant state authority or grant-awarding body
- Confirmation of your address in Slovenia (e.g. rental contract or owner's statement), if applying inside Slovenia

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- Accepted proof includes:
 - Bank statements or savings showing sufficient funds
 - A scholarship or grant confirmation
 - A written statement from parents or legal guardians, if they are legally obliged to support you under the law of your home country
 - An employment contract or job offer, if you intend to work in Slovenia

6. Applying for a Residence Permit After Arrival

You must register your place of residence at the nearest administrative unit within 3 days of entering Slovenia.

Correction (infotujci.si): Third-country nationals holding a valid temporary residence permit must register their place of temporary residence at the competent administrative unit within **8 days** of taking up temporary residence at that address (or within 8 days of the permit being served, if already residing at the address). The 3-day rule applies only to those who do not require a residence permit or visa to enter Slovenia, who must register at the nearest police station within 3 days of entry.

Source: infotujci.si — Registration of residence.

If you did not already receive your residence permit abroad, you must submit your application at the competent administrative unit before your authorised 90-day stay (or your visa/permit, if shorter) expires.

You will be issued a certificate of timely application, valid as a temporary residence permit while your case is being decided.

Once approved, you collect your residence permit card (an additional card fee applies).

7. Working While Studying

A non-EU student holding a temporary residence permit for study purposes is permitted to take up employment or perform work in Slovenia, under the conditions set by the laws governing employment relationships and student work.

In practice, most international students work through the "student work" (studentsko delo) system, via a licensed Student Service agency, using a referral form.

Official Slovenian sources do not specify a fixed maximum number of working hours per week for this type of student work; instead, the system is regulated through registration with a Student Service, tax withholding rules, and the requirement to maintain valid student status.

Non-resident foreign students are subject to a 22.5% income tax withholding on student work earnings, which may be refundable depending on any double-taxation treaty between Slovenia and your home country.

Correction (fu.gov.si): The applicable withholding rate for non-resident students performing student work in Slovenia is **25%** (not 22.5%). A reduced rate or exemption may apply if a double-taxation agreement (DTA) between Slovenia and the student's country of residence contains a special provision for students, and the student obtains prior authorisation from the Slovenian tax authority. Source: Financial Administration of the Republic of Slovenia — Taxation of individuals, non-residents in Slovenia (fu.gov.si).

8. Renewing the Residence Permit for Courses Longer Than One Year

A residence permit for study purposes is issued for the duration of the course, but for a maximum of one year at a time.

If your studies last longer than one year, the permit must be extended annually.

You must apply for the extension at the competent administrative unit before your current permit expires.

The renewal is granted under the same conditions that applied to the original issuance (proof of enrolment, sufficient funds, health insurance, etc.).

9. Changing a Study Residence Permit into a Work Permit

Process:

1. Secure a job offer in Slovenia.
2. Your future employer initiates an application for an employment permit.
3. You apply for a further temporary residence permit (for the purpose of employment) at the competent administrative unit.
4. This must be done before your current study residence permit expires.

In-country applications (i.e. without leaving Slovenia) are possible for this change of purpose.

There is also a specific residence category for foreigners who have completed studies in Slovenia and want to stay to seek employment or self-employment.

10. Official Information Sources

- gov.si — Ministry of the Interior: residence permits and migration policy
- gov.si — Ministry of Foreign Affairs: Slovenia's representations abroad
- infotujci.si — "Information for Foreigners," the official government portal for third-country nationals (residence permits, conditions, document requirements)
- e-uprava.gov.si — Slovenia's national e-government portal (administrative procedures, some online services)
- home-affairs.ec.europa.eu — EU Immigration Portal, "Student in Slovenia" page (official EU Commission summary, cross-referencing Slovenian law)
- pirs.si — Register of legal acts, for the Foreigners Act and the Rules on issuing residence permits

11. Where to Download Application Forms

Form no. 8/1 (application for issuing or renewing a temporary residence permit for study purposes) is set out in Annex 1 of the Rules on issuing residence permits, the method of capturing fingerprints and the modalities of the termination of the residence permit, published on pirs.si.

The same form is available in person at:

- Slovenian embassies and consular posts abroad
- Administrative units (upravne enote) in Slovenia

General administrative forms and e-services can also be found through e-uprava.gov.si and the gov.si administrative units page.

12. Common Mistakes Students Make (and How to Avoid Them)

Based on the official requirements above, frequent issues include:

- Applying too late: embassy appointments, document translations, and apostilles take time, so start well before your intended travel or course start date.
- **Missing the 3-day registration rule: forgetting to register your address at the administrative unit within 3 days of arrival.**
- **Correction (infotujci.si):** The applicable deadline for third-country nationals with a temporary residence permit is **8 days** from taking up residence at the

registered address (not 3 days from arrival). See Section 6 above. Source: infotujci.si — Registration of residence.

- Letting the permit lapse: not applying for renewal before the current permit expires, especially for multi-year courses.
- Incomplete proof of funds: providing a bank statement that does not cover the full length of the planned stay, or that falls short of the official minimum subsistence amount.
- Untranslated or unlegalised documents: submitting a criminal record certificate or other documents without the required Slovene translation or apostille/legalisation.
- Confusing a short-stay Schengen visa with a residence permit: a visa only allows short-term entry; it does not replace the temporary residence permit needed for the full duration of studies.
- Not checking embassy-specific procedures: assuming all Slovenian embassies use the same appointment or document-submission process, when procedures can vary by location.

Overlooking the in-country application route: not realizing that, in some cases, the first permit can be requested from within Slovenia if already legally present, which can save time compared to applying from abroad.